SESSION 2

Interview Preparation Masterclass

From first impression to final offer — everything you need to know.

SESSION 1 QUICK CHECK

Did you update your resume?
Did you test it on Jobscan?
Drop your score in the chat! 💬

Let's celebrate your progress!

OPENING POLL

What scares you most about interviews?

- A — I freeze on tough questions
- B — I can't introduce myself well
- C — I lose confidence & get nervous
- D — All of the above

How to Approach HR

LinkedIn & Email — The Right Way to Get Noticed

LinkedIn Approach

01

Find the HR/Recruiter

Search: Company Name + HR / Recruiter on LinkedIn

02

Send a Connection Note

"Hi, I am a final year B.Tech CS student. I would love to connect and explore opportunities at your company."

03

Follow-up Message

"Thank you for connecting. Please find my resume attached. I would love to discuss any suitable openings."

04

Follow Up Once Only

If no reply in 5–7 days, send ONE polite follow-up. Never more than twice.

Email Approach

Good Email Template

Subject: Application for Software Engineer – B.Tech CS 2024 Fresher

Dear [HR Name],

I am a final year B.Tech CS student with skills in Python and full-stack development. I am writing to express my interest in software engineer roles at your organization.

I have attached my resume for reference. I would be grateful for an opportunity to discuss how I can contribute.

Warm regards, [Your Name]

✗ Never Do This

- Say 'Please give me a job urgently'
- Use 'Hii' or informal greetings
- Copy-paste to 50 HRs at once
- Message at odd hours like midnight

Types of Interviews

Know exactly what to expect in each round

Round 1 — Screening

Telephonic Interview

10–15 min screening by HR. Tests basic fit.

- Questions about yourself & availability
- Salary expectations & location preference
- Keep resume in front of you

💡 Find a quiet place. Speak slowly and clearly.

Round 2 — Personality

HR Round

Tests personality, attitude & culture fit.

- Tell me about yourself
- Strengths, weaknesses & motivation
- Why this company?

💡 Be confident and enthusiastic. This round is about WHO you are.

Round 3 — Skills

Technical Round

Tests subject knowledge & problem solving.

- DSA, coding & domain concepts
- Explain your projects in detail
- Live problem-solving

💡 Be honest. Say 'I don't know but I'll learn.' Never bluff.

Round 4 — Final

Panel Interview

Multiple interviewers — HR + Tech + Manager.

- Mix of HR & technical questions
- Pressure testing & group assessment
- Make eye contact with ALL panelists

💡 Stay calm. Take a breath before answering. Address everyone.

Most companies run 2–3 rounds. Some run all 4. Now you know exactly what to expect — and how to prepare for each.

How to Introduce Yourself

The 5-Part Formula — 60 to 90 seconds, practiced and confident

01

Who You Are

"I am Rahul Sharma, a final year B.Tech Computer Science student from ABC University."

02

Your Key Skills

"I specialize in Python, full-stack development using React & Node.js, and SQL database management."

03

Experience & Projects

"I built an e-commerce platform using Django handling 500+ users. I interned at XYZ Tech building REST APIs."

04

Why This Company

"I have followed your company and I am impressed by your products. My skills align well with your team's work."

05

Confident Closing

"I am genuinely excited about this opportunity and I am ready to contribute from day one."

⏱ **60–90 seconds max • Practice OUT LOUD 10 times • Never say 'Myself Rahul' • Smile & maintain eye contact**

How to Prepare Before the Interview

Preparation is the difference between nervous and confident

01

Research the Company

✓ Visit website — understand products & services

✓ Check LinkedIn for recent news & updates

✓ Prepare: 'What do you know about us?'

02

Read Your Own Resume

✓ Every line is fair game for questions

✓ Be ready to explain every project in detail

✓ Read it carefully the night before

03

Prepare Documents

✓ 3 printed resume copies (in-person)

✓ Marksheets, ID proof, certificates

✓ PDF resume open on desktop (online)

04

Dress Professionally

✓ Formal always — ironed shirt & trousers

✓ Online: formal top, clean background

✓ Camera at eye level. Good lighting.

05

Practice Out Loud

✓ Record yourself & listen back

✓ Practice self intro 10+ times

✓ Check internet, camera & mic beforehand

Body Language & Confidence

60% of communication is non-verbal — make it count

👁 Eye Contact

✓ Natural confident eye contact. Online — look at CAMERA, not screen.

✗ *Staring or constantly looking down or away.*

🧍 Posture

✓ Sit straight, lean slightly forward. Both feet flat on floor.

✗ *Slouching, crossed arms, leaning too far back.*

🤚 Hand Gestures

✓ Hands on table or lap. Natural gestures are fine and show confidence.

✗ *Fidgeting, tapping fingers, playing with pen or hair.*

😊 Facial Expression

✓ Warm genuine smile when entering and at appropriate moments.

✗ *Blank or overly serious face throughout the conversation.*

🎙 Voice & Pace

✓ Speak clearly at moderate pace. Pause 2–3 secs before answering.

✗ *Speaking too fast. Too many umms, ahhs, basically.*

💻 Online Interviews

✓ Camera at eye level. Clean background. Good lighting. Mute when not speaking.

✗ *Looking down at screen. Noisy or cluttered background.*

Confidence = Being comfortable with not knowing everything — and still showing up fully prepared.

Answering Common HR Questions

Every question has a formula — learn the formula, never go blank again

Q: Tell me about yourself

Formula: Who → Skills → Projects → Why this company → Confident close

"I am Rahul Sharma, B.Tech CS from ABC University. I specialize in Python & full-stack dev. I built an e-commerce platform handling 500+ users. I admire your products and believe my skills align well. I am ready to contribute from day one."

Q: What are your strengths?

Formula: Name the strength → Give a real example → Connect to the role

"Problem solving is a key strength. When a critical bug appeared 3 days before our project deadline, I stayed back, debugged it overnight, and we submitted on time. That composure under pressure is what I bring to this role."

Q: What are your weaknesses?

Formula: Real weakness → Self-awareness → What you are doing to improve

"I used to struggle with public speaking. I recognized it early, joined the college debate club, and volunteered to present in class. I have improved significantly and I continue to work on it actively."

Q: Why do you want to join us?

Formula: Specific company knowledge → Link to your skills → Genuine enthusiasm

"I have been following your company — I am impressed by your fintech products and your recent launch. The problem you are solving is fascinating, and my Python & API skills align well with your team."

Q: Where do you see yourself in 5 years?

Formula: Show ambition → Show commitment → Connect to this company's growth

"I see myself growing into a strong software engineer with deep domain expertise, taking on more responsibility, and moving into a leadership role. I believe this company is the right place to build that journey."

Handling Tough & Tricky Questions

These questions test composure — not just knowledge

Golden Rule: Pause → Breathe → Think 2–3 seconds → Then answer. A composed pause shows maturity, not weakness.

❓ Why should we hire YOU?

Strategy: Connect your specific skills to their needs. Add unique value. Close with enthusiasm.

"I bring Python & full-stack skills with real project experience — an e-commerce platform handling 500+ users. I take ownership, and I am genuinely excited about the problems your team solves. I can contribute from day one."

❓ What is your expected salary?

Strategy: Research beforehand. Give a range, not a fixed number. Show flexibility.

"Based on my research, I am expecting 3–5 LPA. However, I am open to discussion based on the overall package, growth opportunities, and responsibilities the role offers."

❓ Do you have other offers / interviews?

Strategy: Be honest but strategic. Show genuine interest in THIS company specifically.

"Yes, I am exploring a few opportunities. But I want to be honest — this company is my top preference because of the work you do and the growth environment here. I am genuinely excited about this role."

❓ Do you have any questions for us?

Strategy: ALWAYS say yes. Prepare 2–3 smart questions. Never ask about salary in round 1.

"Good questions: 'What does a typical day look like in this role?' / 'What are growth opportunities for someone starting here?' / 'What is the team culture like?'"

Never badmouth your college, professors, or past internship — interviewers notice how you speak about others.

Interview Do's & Don'ts

Your final checklist before every interview

✓ DO THIS

- Arrive 15 mins early (in-person) or log in 5 mins early (online)
- Greet everyone professionally — receptionist, HR, and panelists
- Listen fully before answering. Clarify if you don't understand the question
- Be honest — say 'I don't know but I am willing to learn'
- Send a thank you message to HR after the interview
- Ask about next steps — 'When can I expect to hear back?'

✗ DON'T DO THIS

- Use your phone during the interview — keep it on silent in your bag
- Interrupt the interviewer even if you know the answer
- Lie on your resume or in the interview — background verification exists
- Speak negatively about your college, professors, or past internship
- Go silent on tough questions — pause, breathe, give your best attempt
- Give up after rejection — every 'no' is one step closer to the right 'yes'

Questions?

Drop them in the Zoom chat or raise your hand 🙋

✅ Today We Covered

- ✓ How to approach HR on LinkedIn & email
- ✓ Types of interviews & what to expect
- ✓ Perfect self-introduction formula (5 parts)
- ✓ How to prepare the night before
- ✓ Body language & confidence tips
- ✓ Answers to common HR questions
- ✓ How to handle tough & tricky questions
- ✓ Complete Do's & Don'ts checklist

📝 Your Homework

1. Write & practice your self intro 10 times
2. Research 3 companies you want to apply to
3. Write down answers for 5 HR questions

🚀 Coming Up — Session 3

- 💰 Salary negotiation — how to ask confidently
- 📄 Offer letter breakdown — what to check carefully
- 📊 CTC vs In-hand salary explained
- 🤝 How to handle multiple job offers
- 🌟 First 30 days at your new job

Go practice that self-introduction. Research those companies. See you in Session 3! 🎯